



Social Media Safety



Security Issues on Social Media

Social media is fun and useful, but it also comes with risks. Here are the most common problems you might face and why they matter.



Privacy Leaks

Your personal information (like your phone number, address, or birthday) can be seen by strangers if your privacy settings are weak. Companies may also collect your data and share it with advertisers without your clear permission.

Always check who can see your posts.

Be careful about what you share in public profiles.



Cyberbullying & Harassment

People can send hurtful messages, spread rumors, or post embarrassing photos to make you feel bad. This can happen to anyone, and it can really affect your mental health.

Block and report bullies immediately.

Don't respond to hate 💎 it only makes things worse.

Account Hacking

Fake News & Misinformation

False stories and misleading posts spread quickly on social media. They can trick you into believing something that isn't true, which can cause panic, confusion, or even harm.

Check the source before sharing.

Use fact-checking websites to verify.

Hackers can steal your password and take over your account. They might post spam, send fake messages to your friends, or lock you out completely.

Use strong, unique passwords.

Turn on two-factor authentication (2FA) for extra protection.

Inappropriate Content

You might see violent, sexual, or hateful content that is not suitable for you or your children. This content can be harmful and upsetting.

Use content filters and parental controls.

Report any harmful content you come across.

Scams & Phishing

Fake accounts and messages try to trick you into giving away money or personal information. They often promise prizes, jobs, or love to gain your trust.

Never click on suspicious links.

Don't share financial details with strangers.

 **Remember:** Being aware of these risks is the first step to protecting yourself. Always stay alert and trust your gut  if something feels wrong, it probably is.



Flagging & Reporting Inappropriate Content

Every major platform (like Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, TikTok, and Twitter) gives you a button to report content that breaks the rules. This is called **flagging** or **reporting**. It's one of the most powerful tools you have to keep your community safe.



What should you report?

Hate speech posts that attack people based on race, religion, gender, or sexual orientation.

Violence and gore videos or images showing serious injury or death.

Nudity and sexual content explicit photos or videos that are not allowed.

Bullying and harassment repeated mean comments or threats.

Misinformation false health advice, fake news, or scams.

Impersonation fake accounts pretending to be someone else.



How does reporting work?

Find the post, profile, or message.

Click the **Report** or **Flag** icon (usually three dots or a flag).

Choose the reason that best fits the problem.

Add any extra details if asked (like why you think it's harmful).

Submit your report — it goes to the platform's moderation team.

Most platforms also let you report private messages and comments.



What happens after you report?

The platform reviews your report.
This can take a few hours or a few days.

They may use AI (artificial intelligence) to check it first, then humans look at it.

If they agree it's bad, they will remove the content and might warn or ban the person who posted it.

You'll usually get a notification about the decision.

If you disagree with the decision, you can appeal it.



1. You flag



2. AI & team review



3. Action taken



4. You get update



Important: Don't engage with harmful content ❖ don't reply, share, or "like" it. Just report it and move on. Your report helps everyone!



Laws About Inappropriate Content

Different countries have different rules for social media companies. These laws are made to protect you and to make sure platforms remove harmful content quickly. Here are some of the most important ones 💡 explained simply.

Law / Rule	Where it applies	What it says (in easy words)
Digital Services Act (DSA)	European Union	Platforms must take down illegal content quickly. They also have to be open about how they moderate posts.
Online Safety Bill	United Kingdom	Platforms have a "duty of care" 💡 they must protect users from harm. If they don't, they can be fined big money.
Section 230 (US)	USA	Platforms are not responsible for what users post, but they can remove content if they think it's bad (in good faith).
IT Act 2000 (India)	India	Social media companies must remove unlawful content within 36 hours after someone reports it.
GDPR	European Union	This is about protecting your personal data. Platforms can't use your information without your clear permission.

 **Remember:** Laws change over time. Always check your country's official websites for the most current rules.



Best Practices for Using Social Media

Here are simple habits that will keep you safer and happier online. Follow these tips to protect yourself and help others.



Use strong passwords

Make a password that is long and includes letters, numbers, and symbols. Don't use the same password for every site. Turn on two-factor authentication (2FA) for an extra layer.



Review your privacy settings

Go to your settings and check who can see your posts, your friends list, and your personal info. Set everything to "friends only" or "private" unless you really need it public.



Think before you post

Once you post something, it can stay online forever. Avoid sharing your exact location, your ID number, or anything you wouldn't want your boss or grandmother to see.



Be kind and respectful

Treat others the way you want to be treated. If you see someone being bullied, offer support and report the bully. Don't spread hate or gossip.



Watch out for bots and scams

Don't click on links from unknown people. Be suspicious of messages that promise free money, prizes, or ask for your bank details. If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is.



Protect children and teens

Talk to young people about online risks. Use parental controls on their devices. Teach them to never share personal information and to always tell you if something makes them uncomfortable.



Limit your screen time

Spending too much time on social media can affect your mental health. Set daily limits and take breaks. Go outside, meet friends in person, or read a book.



Share responsibly

Before you share a post, ask yourself: is it true? Is it helpful? Could it hurt someone? If you're not sure, don't share it. Check facts with reliable sources.



Pro tip: Make it a habit to do a "digital spring clean" every few months  go through your friends list, review apps connected to your accounts, and delete old posts you no longer want.



Real-World Case Studies

These true stories show what can go wrong on social media and what we learned from them. They remind us why safety and reporting are so important.

Cambridge Analytica

2018

A company called Cambridge Analytica got personal data from millions of Facebook users without their permission. They used that data to try to influence elections. This was a huge privacy scandal.

What we learned: We should be careful about which apps we connect to our social media accounts. Always read what permissions you are giving.

🔗 Facebook was fined \$5 billion by the US government and had to improve its privacy rules.

Hate Speech in Myanmar

2017–2020

In Myanmar, Facebook was used to spread hate speech against the Rohingya minority. False and violent posts led to real-world attacks and suffering. Facebook was slow to remove the harmful content.

What we learned: Platforms need to act fast to stop dangerous speech. Users should report hate content as soon as they see it.

🚩 Facebook banned many accounts linked to the military and invested in local teams to review content in local languages.

Deepfake Video Goes Viral

2023

A fake video (called a "deepfake") of a political leader was created using AI and shared on Twitter (now X). It looked so real that many people believed it. The platform couldn't remove it fast enough.

What we learned: AI can make very convincing fakes. We must be extra

Instagram and Teen Mental Health

2021

Internal reports from Instagram showed that the app made many teenage girls feel worse about their bodies. The algorithm pushed content that made them compare themselves to others.

critical of videos and check multiple sources before believing them.

 Platforms now use AI to detect deepfakes and require labels on synthetic media. They also work with fact-checkers.

What we learned: Social media can affect our mental health, especially young people. We should limit our use and follow accounts that make us feel good, not bad.

♥ Instagram introduced "Take a Break" reminders and made teen accounts more private by default.